THE SESSION · POST-CLOSE READ

Dow Leads, *Tech Lags*

The Dow rose 1.02% and the S&P 500 rose 0.26% as reports of a possible U.S.–Iran diplomatic proposal lifted sentiment, while the Nasdaq slipped 0.02% and Brent fell 0.56% to $108.94 a barrel. Dividend Strategy +0.72% beat SPY and trailed DVY; Growth Portfolio +0.78% beat IUSG.

S&P 500 ▲ 0.26% NASDAQ ▼ 0.02% DOW ▲ 1.02% VIX ▼ 6.13% BRENT ▼ 0.56%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY — BEAT SPY · TRAILED DVY

+0.72% 1-DAY

FCI	+0.72%
DVY	+1.41%
SPY	+0.37%

YTD **+20.38%** vs DVY +15.74% · SPY +13.70%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO — ▲ BEAT IUSG

+0.78% 1-DAY

FCI	+0.78%
IUSG	−0.08%

YTD **+18.10%** vs IUSG +14.06%

THE SESSION

Stocks finished mostly higher on Tuesday as an unconfirmed report of a Qatari–Pakistani proposal to revive U.S.–Iran diplomacy lifted sentiment and weighed on crude oil, with the Dow leading and technology lagging. The Dow rose 1.02% to 52,496, the S&P 500 rose 0.26% to 7,711 and the Nasdaq slipped 0.02% to 26,425; the VIX fell 6.13% to 17.31. The 10-year Treasury yield traded near 5.11% in the afternoon, below Monday's 5.15% close. Brent fell 0.56% to $108.94 a barrel after trading above $111 earlier in the session, and the diplomatic report remained unconfirmed. Lam Research reports results after the close on Wednesday, and Abbott reports before the open. IBIT rose 0.89% and ETHA rose 1.77%.

The Dividend Strategy rose 0.72%, ahead of SPY's 0.37% gain by 0.35 point and behind DVY's 1.41% gain by 0.69 point, with seventeen of twenty-five holdings higher, seven lower and one unchanged. SS&C rose 2.72% and added about 0.17 point, S&P Global rose 2.43% and added about 0.15 point, and Waste Management rose 2.38%, adding about 0.14 point. Lam Research fell 3.21% and subtracted about 0.10 point ahead of its report, Constellation Energy fell 1.65% and subtracted about 0.09 point, and Genuine Parts fell 5.12%, subtracting about 0.08 point after its third-quarter report.

Sessions in which the Dow leads and technology lags tend to reward cash-generative businesses, while headline-driven moves in oil and yields can reverse quickly; discipline over reacting to any single session tends to reduce erosion over time. ***Think Like an Owner.***

The Growth Portfolio rose 0.78%, ahead of IUSG's 0.08% decline by 0.86 point, with fifteen of twenty-five holdings higher and ten lower. ServiceNow rose 2.88% to $149.54 and added about 0.25 point, NXP Semiconductors rose 3.22% and added about 0.14 point, and Harmony Biosciences rose 3.09%, adding about 0.13 point. Freeport-McMoRan fell 1.23% and subtracted about 0.08 point, with Vertiv and Agnico Eagle each subtracting about 0.04 point. On the year, the Dividend Strategy stands at +20.38% against DVY's +15.74%, a +4.64-point spread, with SPY at +13.70%; the Growth Portfolio stands at +18.10% against IUSG's +14.06%, a +4.04-point spread.

FCI HOLDINGS · NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

PGY +5.22% GROWTH
Rose to $18.34 with no company-specific news identified.

NXPI +3.22% GROWTH
Rose to $237.60 with no company-specific news identified.

HRMY +3.09% GROWTH
Rose to $38.70 with no company-specific news identified.

NOW +2.88% GROWTH
Rose to $149.54 with no company-specific news identified.

DECLINERS

GPC −5.12% DIVIDEND
Fell to $123.52 after third-quarter sales rose 4.2% to $6.5 billion; adjusted earnings of $2.07 per share rose from $1.98, but North America automotive margin narrowed and the company trimmed the top end of its 2026 adjusted earnings outlook to $7.50–$7.75.

LRCX −3.21% DIVIDEND
Fell to $263.45 ahead of its report after the close Wednesday.

CEG −1.65% DIVIDEND
Fell to $258.84 with no company-specific news identified.

ABT −1.31% DIVIDEND
Fell to $102.70 ahead of its third-quarter report before the open Wednesday.

YEAR-TO-DATE STANDING

DIVIDEND STRATEGY
+20.38%
vs DVY +15.74% / SPY +13.70%
Spread vs DVY **+4.64 pts**

GROWTH PORTFOLIO
+18.10%
vs IUSG +14.06%
Spread vs IUSG **+4.04 pts**

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